

## Element B:

The concept of having a mechanical rose that drops petals isn't new based on the number of times the Beauty and the beast play has been performed. Many people/companies have made their own version of the rose and have shared their stories online. One version of the rose is a homemade flower with connection points between the flower and the stem. The petals then drop at the push of a button on a controller. This rose design has a good way for the stage crew to be able to release the petals (a simple controller) and the petals dropping look very realistic. The rose could be improved by making the connection joints less obvious. There is a plastic center and small wires that connect the petals to the stem, and when the rose has no more petals all you can see is a large plastic ring. This destroys the magic of the wilting rose by showing the audience exactly how it worked. An alternative design that we have researched is a rose that has petals connected to the stem with electromagnets, the joint between the petals and the stem are not very noticeable up close and will be practically invisible from a few rows back in the audience. This rose has an extremely complicated design considering the motors used to trigger the petals to fall off and learning how to code/control the electromagnets. This design is also very costly, the user that created it said it took a couple hundred dollars for the raw materials and gave it to the theater with no labor cost. Overall the rose design can be as simple as pulling strings to detach the petals from the stem or switching the rose out between scenes to give the illusion of dropping petals. You can also make it very complex by writing lines of code for an arduino. Our group has taken in these examples along with other tidbits of information from our stakeholders such as Mrs. Moody.

### Works Cited

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